

Step Five

Planning and preparing for the future

The final step in our journey towards financial wellbeing was a late addition – when I first started trying to pull together some kind of framework for the kinds of conversations that I wanted to have about finding peace in our relationships with money, there were just four steps, or pillars. But I had a nagging feeling that something was missing, and I realized that, for most of us, feeling financially secure in the present isn't quite enough to allow a full sense of financial wellbeing to flourish. I realized that I had covered dealing with the financial past, and being mindful and present in the moment, but neglected to talk about planning ahead, even as I was making my own plans for a financial future beyond debt and living month-to-month. If the events of the early 2020s so far have taught us anything, it's that your whole life – including your financial prospects – can change very quickly indeed, due to factors that are completely out of your control, and this has made a lot of people painfully aware of how financially precarious they are.